

Manual external check register

These checks remain manual and are not treated as automated failures.

MC01	Target journal aims/scope Requires live journal website verification.
MC02	Article type and manuscript category Requires current publisher policy check.
MC03	Current word limits Requires target journal-specific instruction check.
MC04	Current figure/table/supplement limits Requires target journal-specific instruction check.
MC05	Current APC/open-access policy Requires current publisher policy check.
MC06	Data/code availability policy Requires current publisher policy check.
MC07	Reference style and formatting Requires journal template or submission system.
MC08	Author list, affiliations and corresponding author details Requires author decision.
MC09	Funding, conflict-of-interest, ethics and acknowledgements Requires author/journal-specific legal and administrative details.
MC10	Repository URL, public release status and license Requires final repository hosting decision.